



▲ This gouache on paper painting by the famous British artist Graham Coton shows the laying of a railway line and the construction of a tunnel through the Khyber Pass.

An ancient trade route connecting Kabul, Afghanistan, and Peshawar (in modern-day Pakistan), the Khyber Pass had always been susceptible to invaders seeking to expand their territory into the Indian subcontinent. Crucial to the defence of the country, it was naturally a matter of grave concern. One of the biggest challenges, besides the unforgiving terrain, was the politics of the region.

Impregnable India